

Lopez, Salvador P. “Bataan has Fallen” Presidential Museum and Library. Accessed October 28, 2020. <http://malacanang.gov.ph/1226-bataan-has-fallen/>

A well-written but little-known broadcast piece about the struggle of the Filipino and American soldiers, "Bataan has fallen" is the surrender announcement of the Filipino and American forces against the Japanese forces during the World War II. It was radio broadcasted inside Malinta tunnel in the evening of April 9, 1942. This message was written by Captain Salvador P. Lopez, who later became the Philippine Ambassador to the United Nations and President of the University of the Philippines. The announcement was delivered by 3rd Lieutenant Normando Ildefonso "Norman" Reyes on the "Voice of Freedom" radio broadcast.

EXCERPT:

**RADIO BROADCAST MESSAGE, AS WRITTEN BY CAPTAIN SALVADOR P. LOPEZ,
DELIVERED BY THIRD LIEUTENANT NORMANDO ILDEFONSO “NORMAN” REYES ON
THE “VOICE OF FREEDOM” RADIO BROADCAST OF APRIL 9, 1942 FROM MALINTA
TUNNEL, CORREGIDOR:**

Bataan has fallen. The Philippine-American troops on this war-ravaged and bloodstained peninsula have laid down their arms. With heads bloody but unbowed, they have yielded to the superior force and numbers of the enemy.

The world will long remember the epic struggle that Filipino and American soldiers put up in the jungle fastness and along the rugged coast of Bataan. They have stood up uncomplaining under the constant and grueling fire of the enemy for more than three months. Besieged on land and blockaded by sea, cut off from all sources of help in the Philippines and in America, the intrepid fighters have done all that human endurance could bear.

For what sustained them through all these months of incessant battle was a force that was more than

hardship and adversity could not destroy! It was the thought of native land and all that it holds most dear, the thought of freedom and dignity and pride in these most priceless of all our human prerogatives.

The adversary, in the pride of his power and triumph, will credit our troops with nothing less than the courage and fortitude that his own troops have shown in battle. Our men have fought a brave and bitterly contested struggle. All the world will testify to the most superhuman endurance with which they stood up until the last in the face of overwhelming odds.

But the decision had to come. Men fighting under the banner of unshakable faith are made of something more than flesh, but they are not made of impervious steel. The flesh must yield at last, endurance melts away, and the end of the battle must come.

Bataan has fallen, but the spirit that made it stand—a beacon to all the liberty-loving peoples of the world—cannot fall!

All of us know the story of Easter Sunday. It was the triumph of light over darkness, life over death. It was the vindication of a seemingly unreasonable faith. It was the glorious resurrection of a leader, only three days before defeated and executed like a common felon.

Today, on the commemoration of that Resurrection, we can humbly and without presumption declare our faith and hope in our own resurrection, our own inevitable victory.

We, too, were betrayed by Judases. We were taken in the night by force of arms, and though we had done wrong to no man, our people were bound and delivered into the hands of our enemies. We have been with mock symbols of sovereignty, denied by weaklings, lashed with repeated oppression, tortured and starved. We have been given gall to drink, and we have shed our blood. To those who look upon us from afar it must seem the Filipino people have descended into hell, into the valley of death. But we know that the patient and watching men who said their simple prayers in the hills of Bataan, have not lost faith, and we know that the hushed congregations in the churches throughout the land, drew from the gospel as Mass renewed hope in their resurrection. To all of them we give today the message of the angel of Easter morning: “Be not afraid, for He is risen.”

We, too, shall rise. After we have paid the full price of our redemption, we shall return to show the scars of sacrifices that all may touch and believe. When the trumpets sound the hour we shall roll aside the stone before the tomb and the tyrant guards shall scatter in confusion. No wall of stone shall then be strong enough to contain us, no human force shall suffice to hold us in subjection, we shall rise in the

Recto, Claro M. *Three Years of Enemy Occupation, The Issue of Political Collaboration in the Philippines*. Manila: People's Publishers. 1946.

Claro M. Recto held positions under the Laurel administration during the Japanese occupation. He was the Commissioner on Education, Health and Public Welfare from 1942-1943 and the Minister of State for Foreign Affairs from 1943-1944. After the war, he was arrested and tried for collaboration. In 1946, he wrote a defense and explanation of his stand in his book, *Three Years of Enemy Occupation* which narrated the views and actions of the Filipino elite during World War II. Known for his academic excellence and nationalist ideas, Recto fought his legal battle in court and was acquitted.

In this excerpt, Recto highlighted the different views of the Americans and the Filipinos on the issue of collaboration. According to him, the Americans who remained in the security of their homes and were miles away from the brutality of the Japanese forces cannot appreciate the courage of the Filipinos who faced the brutality of the Japanese conquerors. The Filipino leaders on the other hand were more aware of the nature and character of events in the Philippines and should not be “judged by standards of post-liberation thinking.”

EXCERPT:

Differences in points of view between Americans and Filipinos on the question of collaboration

Three and a half years under the Japanese rule the Filipinos suffered a living death. They came to expect that each day would be their last upon this earth. They went through nameless tortures and indignities. Hunger was to them a physical, gnawing pain, to which hundreds succumbed daily in the streets, in the internment and prison camps, in the filthy dungeons of the military police. The American planes that began to come in September 1944, sweeping and irresistible, caused damage to civilian properties and casualties among the people. Later, more of them were to meet death on the beaches bombed and shelled by Americans, in contested areas in the path of their advancing forces and, finally, in the terrible holocaust that reduced Manila and other cities and towns into rubble and ashes. Still, the Filipinos kept their faith. For their loyalty to the United States they paid the supreme price in countless innocent men, women and children abused and butchered by the Japanese, in thousands of homes destroyed; but even that was not too much to pay for redemption and, they hoped, for the peace that was to follow.

However, it seems that peace and concord are not for them. Openly or behind the scenes, forces

are selfishly at work pulling wires that may plunge the country into more suffering and more misery. Now that the Filipinos need more than ever to be united, they hurl accusations and

299

recriminations against one another, the bitterness of which is in no way assuaged by the American leaders who, having expressed concern for their present situation, should be among the first to deplore the existence of internal dissension here. These men against whom principally the accusations are made have so far kept their silence; their hearts they still preserve the solicitude that, during all their years of public service, they have felt for the country and for the people; and in the spirit of true leadership that those years have instilled in them, they did not wish to make matters worse by accepting their accusers' challenge to a public discussion, which would be unavoidably fraught with passion and prejudice.

Those who alone can pass is easy to defy the enemy if one is thousands of miles away.

They have unquestioning faith in the judgment of their countrymen who remained here with them under the Japanese rule and saw at first hand their acts and inner motivations. The man in the street, the humble farmer in the field, the employee in the government, the true guerrilla who fought and suffered a thousand hardships not because of ambition for personal glory and postliberation political power, but because of pure desire to help the American cause; yes, the American prisoner of war and civilian internee—these are the ones who are in a position to pass correct judgment upon these leaders, because together they inseparably underwent, bore the brunt of, and pulled through three long years of Japanese hell on earth. Not those who were able to escape abroad to engage in profitable undertakings or who fled to mountains not to fight the enemy but for reasons of personal safety, and lived there in comparative comfort and ease of mind, coming out of their self-exile and hiding enriched and acclaimed as heroes and superpatriots, only after the Japanese had all but surrendered to the returning victorious American armies. And certainly not those who are without that virtue of humility which is the beginning of wisdom—those pharisees who themselves served in the two puppet governments and their instrumentalities if only in a subordinate capacity and then retired when they found that the buy-and-sell mart was more profitable, and now appear, after the Japanese have been driven out, in heroes' and patriots' clothing, because in their peacock's vanity they fail to perceive that they too have feet of clay.

At this juncture, it seems opportune to remind ourselves of the words of a French physician, a member of the French underground. to Demaree Bess, who quoted the statement in his article 'Which Way Will France Go?' appearing in the Saturday Evening Post's issue of November 18, 1944: 'Frenchmen who lived abroad came back here with preconceived notions about so-called collaboration, notions which are now being altered. It was easy, in New York or London, to be openly defiant of Germans, and it was tempting for the emigres to be self-righteous when they first returned home. But as they talk with those of us who stayed here, they are beginning to understand better what it meant to live under German occupation. The overwhelming majority

of Frenchmen never left France, and their judgments about who were and who were not collaborators are beginning to prevail."

300

The American point of view

Washington high officials and the rest of the American people who throughout the war remained in the security of their homes thousands of miles away cannot begin to appreciate the utter misery and defenselessness of the Filipinos in the face of the unexampled brutality and lack of principle of the Japanese conqueror. They cannot truly understand the bargainings, the evasions, the temporizings and the show of apparent cooperation with which the Filipinos had to placate the ruthless invader until America could organize and bring back here her mighty armed forces. At best, the American point of view with respect to the Philippines could not but be purely objective, so much so that according to Admiral Richardson, former Pacific Fleet Commander, in his recent testimony before the Pearl Harbor Investigating Committee. President Roosevelt told him in 1940 that he (the President) doubted whether the United States would enter the war even if Japan attacked the Philippines, but that the Japanese could not always avoid making mistakes. That mistake was the attack on Pearl Harbor. At the hearings before the Congressional Committee investigating Pearl Harbor it has been disclosed that in the high command conference held in February 1941, General George C. Marshall, then and until recently Chief of Staff, made the following statement: ' "We really have two active defense issues—the Panama Canal and Honolulu. They are the two great outposts of our defense. We have some troops in the Philippines but the Philippines are so weak they could not be defended against any first class power. They would have to be sacrificed." General Marshall testified also before the committee saying that "he knew of no agreement before the Pearl Harbor attack committing the United States to war unless she was attacked."

After these meaningful revelations, paradoxical though it may sound, we Filipinos should feel happy that the Japanese made the mistake of attacking Pearl Harbor. That mistake decided the fate of Filipino democracy and civilization. Had the Japanese attack been directed against the Philippines alone, the Filipinos, out of their loyalty to America, would probably have been in the tragic situation of fighting America's war without America even being a belligerent. That, as the Americans would say, would have left the Filipinos hanging out on a limb. And with America out of the war, the Philippines, after a futile resistance which could have lasted month only, would have been definitely incorporated into the Japanese empire, not even as an ostensibly sovereign member of the co-prosperity sphere, because such propaganda stunt would have been superfluous, but as a mere colonial possession like Korea and Formosa.

But Pearl Harbor was attacked and America entered the war. It was not America, however, but the Philippines that became the gory battlefield of the war, and for over three years was virtually

converted into one big prison camp. It was not American cities that were destroyed, American homes burned. fields laid waste, food supplies confiscated, private belongings looted, population

301

decimated by the action of the ruthless enemy. No American in the United States was deprived of his home and thrown into the street; or ever lived in stark. abiding fear of the Japanese spy and military police; or found himself between "non-cooperation" and the enemy torture-chamber; or felt the sting of a slap in his face, the cold steel of a bayonet in his entrails, the pain of burning flesh, or any of the countless torture methods employed by the Japanese. It was only natural that the primary concern of the United States should be to win the war and to save as many American lives as possible in the process. The retaking of the Philippines was not an end in itself but part of an overall strategic plan. And when it came to the final execution of that plan, the objective approach toward the plight of the Filipinos had to be maintained, even at the cost of almost completely obliterating Manila and other cities and towns and killing thousands of civilians as a result of the intense bombing and shelling.

The Filipino point of view

On the other hand, the Filipino leaders who were left here. During the occupation could not, for the very reason that they are Filipinos, adopt the same detached attitude toward their country. They had to tax their ingenuity and make the most of their practical wisdom to meet the grave implications of the enemy invasion and occupation, in the face of the defenselessness and bewilderment of the people. They had to feign cooperation and pretend to play into the hands of the wily enemy because the latter was not only suspicious but already convinced that the Filipinos were just waiting for the opportune moment to strike back. True they wished. as fervently as did the Americans themselves, an American victory But at the same time, while they could not plan to bring about that victory they had to face perplexing problems that were immediate and no less urgent. While their faith in the ultimate triumph of American arms never faltered, they had to plan not for a month or two of enemy rule but for a protracted period that might well drag for many years. For America was, by her own admission. hopelessly unprepared and the prodigious scientific achievements and productive power that were to turn the tide eventually in her favor were not then reasonably foreseeable in the near future. In the midst of those terrible realities this handful of Filipino leaders was entrusted with the task of looking after the well-being of their own people and trying to save the country from abject misery, even possible extinction. How well and effectively they went about that task, only those whom they served are competent to judge, not those in whose very selfishness the enemy found comfort and assistance. President Osmena himself, in his Leyte speech, said that there were those among the men who held public office during the Japanese occupation who were prompted by a desire to protect the people and comfort them in their misery, and to prevent the Japanese from governing directly and completely or utilizing unscrupulous Filipino followers capable of any treason to their people.

So, while the Filipinos who headed the government under the Japanese occupation, intent as they were upon speeding up the liberation of the Philippines, were exultant over the formation of

302

guerrilla units, because these meant so much to the American war strategy, they could not, on the other hand, feel so happy when the unwitting exploits of some of the guerrillas brought about reprisals and death to whole communities of innocent people. And while the Americans, unaware of the real nature and character of the events here, could close their eyes to the countless robberies, rapes and murders committed by lawless elements in the name of the resistance movement but really prompted by lust and personal vengeance, if not from motives of banditry pure and simple, these Filipino leaders could not so callously ignore them but, being powerless to repress them effectively, at least had to morally condemn them, because such horrible crimes and abuses had for their victims thousands of Filipinos and in the end weakened the power of resistance of our people against the common enemy.

The conduct and actuations of the Filipino leaders cannot be judged by standards of post liberation thinking.

Some would say that for all their good intentions the efforts of these Filipino leaders were of no avail, as they were not able to prevent the enslavement of the people. Considering the implacable enmity and bitter resentment between the Japanese and the great masses of the people, which was daily coming to a crisis, and the deep distrust professed by the Japanese toward the Filipino officials, it is doubtful whether any group of men could have done better in the interest of their people. It is a matter of public knowledge that there was at the time a current saying among the Japanese to the effect that with the exception of Ricarte and Ramos and their followers, the Filipinos were ninety-five per cent pro-Americans and five per cent liars. Under those circumstances their efforts to protect the people could not meet with eminent success. But that fact does not make them criminals; and it is unfair to judge their actuations at the time, when the nation was dazed by defeat and everything was chaos and confusion, through the perspective of victory and by the present standards of post-liberation thinking. They started with hopefulness in the efficacy of what they had expected to do, but they could not then know the relentless character of Japanese bestiality and double-dealing they had to put up with later on, progressively became worse as the Japanese realized more and more the hostility and double crossing tactics of the Filipinos, officials and masses alike. At any rate the events of the last four months of the occupation have shown that if there had been no pretense of co-operation the indiscriminate slaughter of the Filipinos would have been carried out from the beginning and there would have been only a handful of them left to liberate in the end.

What would the Americans have done?

It would be interesting, from the academic point of view, to know what would have happened if the Japanese had pressed their initial success at Pearl Harbor and actually occupied Hawaii or some part of the American mainland along the Pacific coast. Would the Americans in those

303

places have shown an absolutely uncompromising stand and resisted the enemy to the last unarmed and defenseless man? Or while biding their time would they have also temporized and bargained for terms that would give them at least a reasonable chance of survival? The Americans in the Philippines, both soldiers and civilians, who surrendered to the Japanese or were captured or interned, did exactly this. Self-preservation, individual or national, is an instinct common to men of all races and to all countries of the world. If the war had been between the Philippines and Japan as the principal belligerents the Filipinos would probably have found some measure of protection in that very status. But the war was between the United States and Japan, and the Philippines became involved only because it was under American sovereignty. It was a situation that was exploited to the fullest extent by the Japanese and made the basis of their propaganda that the Filipinos were not their enemies but brother Orientals whom they had come to free. At the same time it was used to justify the measures of coercion and punishment they employed, because if the Filipinos were not enemies they could not plead their pro-Filipinism as an excuse for openly refusing to cooperate with the Japanese. Such refusal meant, in the Japanese eyes, only one for and attachment to the Americans, and this in turn meant certain torture or death.

Not only the Americans in the Philippines at the time of Pearl Harbor but also the Filipinos were sacrifice to America's unpreparedness.

The problems thus faced at the time by these Filipinos now accused of political collaboration were, from the subjective point of view, much more difficult than those faced by the Americans who were concerned exclusively with the conduct and strategy of the war. The difference is so patent officials and certain sectors or the American press, is perhaps unconsciously fortified in its condemnation of these so-called political collaborationists by the belief that the moral fiber of a Filipino is weaker than that of an American, so that where one would be betraying his country by certain acts under a given situation the other would be incapable of intending such betrayal by similar acts under a similar situation. Nothing else can explain why those brave American soldiers who surrendered to the Japanese in the Philippines and who were forced to make statements plainly pro-Japanese or tending to give comfort to the enemy. should be lionized and acclaimed as the heroes they really are, while the Filipinos who were forced to make similar statements are now accused of having given aid and comfort to the enemy and are condemned in the eyes of the world even before they are accorded a trial. There is somewhere the purpose of

exacting a higher measure of loyalty from the Filipinos than from America's own nationals. No other explanation can be conceived of why General Wainwright, and the other American generals and officers under his command, for instance, were, as President Truman said, a sacrifice to America's state of unpreparedness, while the Filipinos who perforce had to deal and bargain with the Japanese on account of that very unpreparedness should now be called traitors. While it is

304

true that these Americans were prisoners of war, from the standpoint of freedom to act, both they and the Filipinos were not free agents; they were both under pressure, taking orders. In a sense the pressure exerted on them from the erstwhile conquerors. Filipinos was greater, because while an American could not be properly requested to make a pro-Japanese or an anti-American statement, a Filipino who would decline to make not an anti-Filipino but a pro-Japanese or an anti-American statement would appear in the eyes of the Japanese as pro-American and, therefore, an enemy of Japan.

“Executive Order No 40: Initiating A National Campaign For The Cultivation Of Idle Lands To Produce Food Crops.” *Presidential Museum and Library*. <http://malacanang.gov.ph/6369-executive-order-no-40-s-1942/>

Jorge B. Vargas was designated to be the executive secretary of President Laurel during the Second Republic. He issued this executive order on a national campaign that will enforce local officials to produce food in idle land in the midst of food shortage brought by the war.

The document showed which food was prioritized for cultivation. Among these prioritized foods were rice, corn, camote, cassava, gabi, cowpeas, soybeans, mongo. The document also allowed local officials such as governors and mayors to distribute uncultivated public lands within their respective jurisdictions to preferably unemployed for one year.

EXCERPT:

OFFICE OF THE CHAIRMAN OF THE EXECUTIVE

COMMISSION

MALACAÑAN PALACE

BY THE CHAIRMAN OF THE EXECUTIVE COMMISSION

EXECUTIVE ORDER NO. 40

INITIATING A NATIONAL CAMPAIGN FOR THE CULTIVATION OF IDLE LANDS TO
PRODUCE FOOD CROPS.

305

WHEREAS, as a consequence of the present emergency, many farms are abandoned and the country is threatened with food shortage;

WHEREAS, the importation of essential food commodities is problematical under the present circumstances; and

WHEREAS, food crops must be grown in order to avert hunger and forestall famine throughout

the land;

NOW, therefore, pursuant to the authority conferred upon me as Head of the Central Administrative Organization by Order No. 1 of the Commander-in-Chief of the Imperial Japanese Forces in the Philippines, and upon the recommendation of the Executive Commission, it is hereby ordered:

1. That a nation-wide campaign for the cultivation of rice, corn, camote, cassava, gabi, cowpeas, soybeans, mongo and other short-time food crops suited to local conditions, be started at once under the joint sponsorship of the Department of the Interior and the Department of Agriculture and Commerce.

2. That it shall be the duty of all city and municipal mayors to distribute uncultivated public lands within their respective jurisdictions among the citizens thereof preferably to those who are unemployed in order to enable them to plant food crops therein for a period of one agricultural year.

3. That if for any reason the owner or the one in possession of any private land is unable to cultivate the same, it shall be the duty of the mayor of the city or municipality where such land is located to turn it over to the citizens of such city or municipality preferably to those who are unemployed for the same purposes and under the same conditions prescribed in the next preceding paragraph.

4. That it shall be the duty of every person or persons to whom public or private land has been turned over for cultivation to carry into effect the national food production campaign by planting thereon the crops contemplated in paragraph 1 of this Order: Provided, That they may not alter or damage any permanent improvements existing thereon: And provided, further, That *kaiñgin* may not be resorted to without permission from the Director of Forestry and Fishery or of his representative in the locality. When a portion of public lands is found more suited for agricultural than for forest purposes *kaiñgin* shall be allowed.

5. That crops obtained on public and private lands distributed in accordance with paragraphs 2 and 3 of this Order shall belong to the grower and no rent for the use of the land shall be

306

collected: Provided, however, That a portion of the crops or so much thereof as may be necessary, not exceeding ten per centum, shall be set aside and the proceeds therefrom turned over to the Government as payment of the real estate tax corresponding to the year in which such crops are gathered or harvested.

6. That it shall be the duty of all provincial governors personally or through the agricultural

supervisors, to inspect the activities of the mayors in this food production campaign. The governors and city mayors shall also submit a monthly report to the Commissioner of the Interior and the Commissioner of Agriculture and Commerce on the progress of the campaign in their respective provinces and cities.

7. That it shall be the duty of all provincial governors and city or municipal mayors who may receive seeds, seedlings, cuttings, shoots, or tubers from the Government in the furtherance of the national food production campaign to distribute such seeds, seedlings, cuttings, shoots, or tubers immediately to the farmers for planting, and it shall be unlawful for them to utilize the same for their own benefit, or to intentionally permit or give tacit consent to the diversion of the same for consumption purposes.

8. That any person who neglects or fails to perform any duty enjoined by this Order, or who performs any act which defeats or tends to defeat its purposes, or who otherwise violates any provision thereof, shall upon conviction be punished with imprisonment not exceeding six months, or by fine not exceeding two hundred pesos, or by both such fine and imprisonment, at the discretion of the court.

9. That the provincial governors and city or municipal mayors who infringe the provisions of this Order shall, in addition to the criminal responsibility to which they may be subject, also be liable to suspension or removal from office.

10. This Executive Order shall be printed in Japanese, English, and in the principal dialects of the Philippines for distribution in all cities and municipalities.

Done in the City of Greater Manila, Philippines, this 14th day of May, 1942.

(Sgd.) JORGE B. VARGAS

Chairman of the Executive Commission
307